



Mental Health A.L.E.R.T.S



Barts Health
NHS Trust

A visual checklist for patients that present with self-harm/overdose or suicidal ideation

A ssess early



Start MH triage on arrival
Aim to assess in 15-30min

L isten & Liase



Concerns in patients own words
Contact Psych liaison early
Escalate if appropriate

E ngage compassionately



Offer food/drink
Give clear explanations
Document compassionate care

R ecord clearly



Record type of self harm, Triggers,
Patient description, Future plans,
Brief psych/social history

T ake action



Document risk level
[low/medium/high]
Match observation to risk

S afeguarding



Screen for: dependents, abuse,
homelessness, exploitation
If did not wait, record action taken



Risk Classification & Observation Level



Low Risk

No immediate suicidal ideation, co-operative, protective factors present

Observation

Intermittent check every 15-30 minutes



Medium Risk

Thoughts present but no plan/intent, previous self-harm, vulnerable

Observation

Continuous line of sight, remove ligature/sharps



High Risk

Active plans, recent attempt, intent, means available, unable to guarantee safety

Observation

1:1 constant observation, immediate review, escalate